of the requirement of the mother and that required to make up the iron lost in breast milk. Since there is an amenorrhea during lactation the basal requirement will be same as in adult women 14µg/kg.

d) Vitamins

i) Vitamin A

The quantity of retinol present in 680 ml of human milk is 50µg, so the ICMR recommends an additional allowance of 350µg of retinol. This can be achieved by including liver, fish liver oil, egg yolk, milk and green leafy vegetables in the diet.

ii) Thiamine, Riboflavin, Niacin

Thiamine content of mother's milk depends on mother's diet. Dietary allowances for thiamine for lactating mothers is 0.5 mg/1000 kcal and their daily requirement is computed on the basis of their energy allowance. The additional allowance recommended by ICMR (2010) on the basis of additional calorie allowances 0.3 mg for 0 to 6 months lactation and 0.2 mg for 7-12 months.

Additional allowance of riboflavin corresponding to the increased energy allowance would be 0.3 mg. RDA for riboflavin during lactation is computed on the basis of 0.6 mg 1000 kcal. If the diet meets the requirement of protein and calcium the requirement of riboflavin would be definitely met. Milk is not only a good source of calcium but also a good source of riboflavin.

The nicotinic acid content of the breast milk of Indian women ranges between 100 and 150µg per 100ml. The amount lost in milk is between 0.9 and 1.2 mg per day. The dietary allowances for niacin is 6.6 mg niacin equivalents per 1000 kcals.

iii) Folic acid

The folic acid content of breast milk secreted by Indian women is 1.6µg per 100ml.

Table 2.5 ICMR recommended dietary allowances of a lactating mother-2010

Nutrient	Normal women	Lactating women	
		0-6 months	7-12 months
Energy Kcals			
Sedentary work	1900		
Moderate work	2230	+600	+520
Heavy work	2850		
Protein gm	55	77.9	70.2
Fats gm	30	30	30
Calcium mg	600	1200	1200
Iron mg	21	25	25
Vitamin A			
Retinol µg	600	950	950
Carotene µg	4800	7600	7600
Thiamine mg			
Sedentary work	1.0		
Moderate work	1.1	+0.3	+0.2
Heavy work	1.4		
Riboflavin mg			
Sedentary work	1.1		
Moderate work	1.3	+0.4	+0.3
Heavy work	1.7		
Niacin equivalent (g)			
Sedentary work	12		
Moderate work	14	+4	+3
Heavy work	16		
Pyridoxine mg	2.0	2.5	2.5
Ascorbic acid mg	40	80	80
Dietary folate µg	200	300	300
Vitamin B12 µg	1.0	1.5	1.5
Magnesium	310	310	310
Zinc	10	12	12

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